

**UROMI JDCPI**  
**CORPORATE FACT SHEET**

|                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name                                 | Uromi Justice Development Peace & Caritas Initiatives                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Owner                                | Catholic Diocese of Uromi, Nigeria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Legal Holder                         | His Lordship, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Aihmiosion Ogun (OSA)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Authorized Representative & Director | Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Oriabure Arhedo                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Corporate Registration No:           | CAC/IT/No: 500042 & ED/MWASD/NGOR/200/04                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Status                               | Catholic Non-Governmental, Non-Profit making, humanitarian and development organization                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Motto                                | Hope and empowerment for the oppressed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Areas of operation                   | Integral Development, Human Rights, Democracy and Good Governance, Alternative Dispute Resolution, Peace Building, Micro-Credit and Caritas, TB, HIV/AIDS care and Counseling                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Project steered                      | Conflict Management, Training of Electorate, Election Observation, Budget Monitoring, Community TB Care, HIV/AIDS Awareness Creation & Counseling, Micro-Credit Facilities, Rural Community Development Enlightenment Campaign, Prisoners' Welfare Services, Gender And Child Rights, Widowhood Association, Human Rights, Training Programmes for Police Officers and Youths, Women Development & Promotion, Legal Aid and VC Programming |
| Focus Group                          | The rural populace, the economically deprived families, children, students, youths, women and widows living among the poorest of the poor in the society. Inmates in Prison and Ex-inmates and those stigmatized with deadly diseases                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Corporate Office                     | Uromi JDPCI, Catholic Chancery Egbele Quarter, Uromi, Edo State                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Physical Address                     | Inside Uromi Diocesan Chancery at Egbele Quarter, Uromi, Edo State                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Postal Address                       | P.O. Box 7, Uromi, Edo State                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| E-mail                               | <a href="mailto:uromijdpci@gmail.com">uromijdpci@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Telephone:                           | +2348034930414, +2348150822522, +2348150822542, ,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

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|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                       | +2348150822558                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Auditors              | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Grant Thornton.<br/>CHARTERED Accountants, Benin Branch</li> <li>2. Edforte, Fortne, Ehiagwina &amp; Associates<br/>141 Benin-Auchi Road Ekpoma, Edo State</li> </ol>                                                                                  |
| Bankers               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• UBA BANK PLC<br/>Mission Road, Uromi</li> <li>• ECOBANK PLC<br/>Mission Road, Uromi</li> <li>• FIDELITY BANK PLC<br/>Mission Road, Uromi</li> <li>• UNITY BANK PLC<br/>Mission Road, Uromi</li> <li>• UNION BANK PLC<br/>Mission Road, Uromi</li> </ul> |
| Staff Strength        | <b>16</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Registered Volunteers | <b>55</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Project Executed      | 14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## **INTRODUCTION**

The goal of institutionalizing good governance in this quarter took a reasonable and applaudable dimension with the successful conduct of town hall meetings with the newly elected Local Government Chairmen in Edo central Senatorial District. These meetings were tagged round table discussions because the Chairmen were actually not given stewardship but were receiving inputs from their people and explaining their plan in office to them. This was to create a yardstick to measure their activities and achievements in Office as well as helped the people make inputs into the Local Government budget and participate in the governance of their own affair

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives conducted five quarterly meetings across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District in this quarter. The emphasis was on strengthening the relationship and collaboration between the newly elected Local Government Chairmen and their People through the civic groups. Inputs were also taken on the level of community participation in governance and how they were able to influence project to their various communities.

In the course of the meeting the Director Uromi JDPCI gave opening remark in all the Local Government Areas. In his remark he thanked the civic group members for their enthusiastic participation in the round table discussion with the Executive Chairmen of their Local Government Areas and implored them to ensure a follow up on the issues presented as well as to get their Councillors involved in the follow up. He further advised them to take advantage of the platform the council Chairmen have created for the continuous engagement to bring about progress in their respective communities. A dialogue with their councillors was important to constantly remind the Chairman of his promises. He further urged them to be concerned about project going on in their communities through monitoring to ensure that the projects meet standard. He noted that transparency, accountability and participatory democracy were important to achieve community development. He further implored them to collaborate with government for every project sited in their communities to ensure durability and strive to sustain it to the advantage of the community.

## **REPORT OF QUARTERLY MEETINGS HELD ACROSS THE FIVE LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS IN EDO CENTRAL SENATORIAL DISTRICT IN THE MONTH OF JUNE 2018**

### **ESAN CENTRAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA**

Esan Central Civic Group quarterly meeting was held on the 7<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at St. Anselm Children Hall due to the on-going construction at the town hall designated by the Monarch for the meetings. The Director welcomed all the representatives of civic groups across the Local Government Area to the meeting and thereafter took the roll call of groups present. He again thanked them for their enthusiastic participation in the round table discussion with the Executive

Chairman of Esan Central Local Government Area and implored them to ensure a follow up on the issues presented as well as to get their Councillors involved in the follow up.

## REPORTS

**AGUA CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that Grading of roads and renovation of the health centre were the major issues in their community. They have presented to the LGA Chairman and he has promised to give them a good consideration.

**AKHO/EGUARE CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they were still working on getting the bore hole in the area rehabilitated and the evacuation of refuse in the market. He also reported that the group had taken the promises and plan the chairman of Esan Central Local government area had posited during the round table discussion to members of their community members. The representative also said that they were still waiting for the



The supervisor of Esan Central giving a report at the meeting

the council chairman to fulfil his promise to rehabilitate the borehole in the community. He thanked the Director of UROMI JDPCI for providing the technical assistance for

the group to be able to engage authority at the local level.



The Director Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo addressing the gathering.

The Director advised them to identify the stakeholders and committees in the market to sustain the cleanliness in the market.

**IDUMEBO CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they were negotiating with a member of their community who had borehole to allow the community access water from it. He noted that the intervention became necessary following the disagreement among some persons in the community that led to the owner of the borehole stopping the community members from access water from the borehole. They were advised to sensitize their people to respect the kind gesture of the owner of the borehole.

**USENU CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they have discuss with their councillors to follow-up with the issues they presented to the LGA Chairman. The council was also invited to attend their next meeting and he has accepted to be present.



A group photograph of participants with the Director

**EWU CIVIC GROUP:** He stated that the community suffered rainstorm disaster in which roofs of some houses were blown off. He added that they assisted the affected households to approach the appropriate government authorities, and that a week after the rainstorm disaster the commissioner of works in Edo state visited the community to assess the damage and promised to assist victims of the disaster. However as the time of reporting at the quarterly meeting the assistance has not come. The facilitator promised that the civic group has plans to pay a visit to the commissioner to remind him of his promise to assist the victims of the tragic event.

## **ESAN WEST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA**

Esan West Civic Group quarterly meeting was held on the 11<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at the Palace of the Onojie of Ekpoma Kingdom. The Program Manager welcomed all the representatives of civic groups across the Local Government Area to the meeting and thereafter took the roll call of groups present. He again thanked them for their enthusiastic participation in the round table discussion with the Executive Chairman of Esan West Local Government Area and implored them to ensure a follow up on the issues presented as well as to get their Councillors involved in the follow up.

## **REPORTS**

**EMAUDO CIVIC GROUP:** Facilitator reported that refuse dump on the road and the poor condition of their health centres were the major issues discussed in their meeting. He added that outside the presentation they made to LGA Chairman they have also approach some influential persons in their community to prevail on the Chairman. He noted that the refuse is gradually being evacuated.

**UJOELEN CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they have approach the community elders to schedule a date for the clearing of the drainage system in the community to allow for free flow of water. They were advised to work on the youths in preparation for the date that the elders will give.

**UKHUN CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they suggested to the Monarch the need to clear a spot that seem to be a hide out for criminals. The Monarch gave approval and the spot has been cleared.

**EMIALA CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they have dialogued with the youth in their community to clear the drainage to allow free flow of water. The youths accepted and the drainages have been cleared.

**IRUEKPEN CIVIC GROUP:** The facilitator reported that they identified three (3) issues for discussion on which they have been working to resolve. The issues were; inadequate staff in the



A civic group member given report during meeting

General Hospital, inadequate teachers in the secondary school and the clearing of the streets in Iruekpen. He added that efforts are currently on to resolve the situation. He stated that they have approached some persons including the Local Government Chairman to assist them influence the process. They were advised to write a formal letter to the Ministry of Health and copy the Governor, explaining the situation of the General Hospital and what they want the government to do. The Local Government Chairman has already promised to assist with the grading of streets.

**EGORO-AMEDE:** Reported that due to the need to prevent breach of peace in the community, the elders through the intervention of the Civic group is conducting verification and identification of all foreigners in the community. The facilitator appreciated the cooperation they have enjoyed from the foreigners in their community since the commencement of the exercise. They were however advised to civil about it so as not to infringe on people's rights and to avoid discrimination against people based on religion or ethnic group.

**EGUARE CIVIC GROUP:** Reported that they have re-organized their group and that they now have new facilitator and scribe. The facilitator reported their interface with the construction company handling the construction of the major road in Ekpoma and their intervention has stopped the obstruction caused by beer distribution depot to the construction company. They were commanded and tasked to dialogue with the construction company on the need to wet the road under construction regularly to avoid too much dust in the town.



Group photograph of participants after meeting

**UKPENU CIVIC GROUP:** The supervisor reported that he was working with Ukpenu community to call the construction company to order in the area of erosion control which was diverted into the community. He added that discussions were still on-going.

## **ESAN NORTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA**

Esan North East Civic Group quarterly meeting was held on the 13<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at the Palace of the Ojuromi of Uromi Kingdom. The meeting started at 11:10am with opening prayer after which Program Manager welcomed all the representatives of civic groups across the Local Government Area to the meeting and thereafter took the roll call of groups present.

The Director Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo expressed delight and happiness on the successful reconciliation of the traditional ruler with the state government. He also thanked the various communities for standing by the traditional ruler all through the period.



## REPORTS

**EROR CIVIC GROUP** reported that they met with councillor to present items to him for consideration in the LGA budget and that the items were also presented to the chairman during the round table discussion. He was advised to inform the councillor to follow up with the demands presented to the Chairman since he already has the items too.

**EGBELE CIVIC GROUP** reported that the Local Education Authority has informed the community that their (Afuda) primary school was approved for reconstruction. This was a respond to series of letters and appeal made by the community to relevant authorities for the school to be given attention.

**IVUE CIVIC GROUP** reported that on request they provided technical support to Ivue primary school to assist the school with more teachers. This was in response to the appeal by the head teacher to



A group photograph of the Director and participants at the meeting.

assist the Primary school with more teachers as their staff strength was grossly inadequate to meet the teaching needs of the children. Though they have advised the head teacher to write a request letter to Local Education Authority, the community was also encouraged to write a follow up letter to Local Education Authority to support the demands of the headmistress but that in the interim, community teachers may have to be engaged.

**AMEDOKHIAN CIVIC GROUP** reported that Construction Company working in their community has accepted the responsibility to repair any damage caused by their work or activities in the community. They have also expressed commitment to replace the broken pipes for water supply which were damaged during the preparatory work in the community.

## IGUEBEN LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Esan West Civic Group quarterly meeting was held on the 13<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at the Palace of the Onojie of Igueben Kingdom. The Program Manager welcomed all the representatives of civic groups across the Local Government Area to the meeting and thereafter took the roll call of groups present after which the Director of Uromi JDPCI gave an opening remark. He noted that transparency, accountability and participatory democracy were important to achieve community development. He



Very Rev. Fr. D. Fidelis Arhedo addressing members at the quarterly meeting



Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo addressing members at quarterly meeting in Igueben LGA

further implored them to corroborate with government for every project sited in their communities and strive to sustain it.

## REPORTS

**EGUARE IGUEBEN Civic Group** reported that the group was working on ways to solve the issue of epileptic electricity supply to the community. He complained that despite the poor supply huge bills were sent to members of the community to payment. He noted that the issue has been reported to the Monarch who has also referred it to Igueben Development Progressive Union. The Director Very Rev. Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo advised the group to discuss with Benin Electricity Distribution Company (BEDC) to get meters for the members of the community so that the cost of their bills will be reduced.

**IDUMEKA Civic Group** reported that they were working to assist the Doctor in the general Hospital with protection, because she felt threatened after attempted attack on her. He added that the council of Chiefs have been informed and they are working to resolve the situation which appears to be misunderstanding between the Doctor and some workers in the health facility.

**EBELLE Civic Group** reported that they have approached the construction company working on the dualization of the federal road to assist them with the creation of more streets in Ebelle as part of their community support and that the company accepted to assist them. He added that government have engaged same persons to clean and clear the drainage system following their request to the appropriate authority. The Director advised them to ensure the security of the staff of the construction company that will be working in their community so as to encourage other groups that may want to work in their community. Facilitator then stated that the vigilante group in their community has been strengthened with more members improve security

**AMAHOR Civic Group** reported that the community have been informed that the road leading to their community of which they have request the State Government assistance and got promises of the government have finally been approved for construction by Niger Delta Development Commission (NDDC). He added that their major challenge was the absence of electricity supply to the community for about nine months. He stated that BEDC has requested them to contribute money to replace their community meter before electricity can be restored to the community. On the issue of exorbitant bills been paid by power consumers in some communities, The Director advised that bulk meters should be purchased to mitigate the high bills been paid.



Group photograph of participants at the meeting in Igueben



**EKPON Civic Group** reported that their community was planning to visit the governor to draw his attention to the secondary schools that got burnt in their community. They were advised to approach the LGA Chairman for possible assistance to influence the process and to let the Monarch lead the delegation. The facilitator added that the Ekpon road requires the assistance of the Local Government for some palliative measures pending when a more comprehensive work will be done on the road. They were told to follow up with the Local Government so as to know when the schedule to do grading and maintenance on roads.

**EWOSSA Civic Group** reported that the group was working on borehole and Primary health care rehabilitation as well as the grading of some roads in their community. However he stated that these demands have been articulated to the Local Government Chairman during the roundtable discussion and the community were still awaiting his intervention in these projects.

### **ESAN SOUTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA**

The quarterly meeting was held on the 16<sup>th</sup> of June 2018 at the Local Government Council hall. The meeting started at 1:45 PM with opening prayers which was followed with opening remark by the Director of Uromi JDPCI Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo after which report was entertained from the various civic groups

### **REPORTS**

**UBIAJA Civic Group** reported that the laboratory that was built by old boys Association of St. John Bosco has been completed and commissioned. He added that they also monitored the construction

work in one of their roads as well as assisted to ensure the evacuation of refuse on one of their major street.



**The Director making the opening remark**

**ORIA Civic Group** reported that their scribe has been elected as councillor to represent their political ward and that they have been engaged in monitoring of the construction of block of class rooms in their school to prevent the contractor from using sub-standard equipment.

**OKHUESAN Civic Group** reported that the European Union has started work on the Health Centre which they promised to provide for the community in place borehole.

**EMU Civic Group** reported that they discussed with the councillor on the needs of the community, which they have also presented to the Local Government Chairman. He appreciated them and promised to be part of their meeting anytime he was around. He added that the gully in their community was visited by a team of experts from the World Bank and State Government to assess the situation and have promised to commence work on the site soon.

**EWATTO Civic Group** reported that their market was in dire need of sanitation and that they have brought it to the attention of the LGA Chairman as such they were hopeful that the situation will improve

**EWOHIMI Civic Group** reported that they visited the newly elected Chairman of the Local Government at his residence in their community to introduce the group to him. He added that he also visited some schools that were assisted by the Chairman with resources to clear round their compound that was over grown with weed and that they clearing have been done in the various schools



The Program Manager facilitating at the meeting

**UGBOHA Civic Group:** The Councillor representing the community was present at the quarterly meeting and promised to revive and strengthen the civic group in Ughoha Community

## **THE ROUND TABLE DISCUSSION/TOWN HALL MEETING HELD ACROSS THE FIVE LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS IN EDO CENTRAL SENATORIAL DISTRICT IN THE MONTH OF MAY, 2018**

### **INTRODUCTION:**

As a way of strengthening participatory democracy and collaboration between the Local Government Representatives and the People, the civic groups in collaboration with Uromi JDPCI organised town hall meetings which was tagged round table discussion with the newly elected Local Government Executive Chairmen across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District. The aim was to provide a sustainable platform for interaction between the people and their representatives as well as institutionalise participatory democracy in which the people can engage their elected officials and present their demands for consideration in the budget. It also afforded the Local Government Chairmen the opportunity to sensitise the people on the plans/policies of the Local Government as well as exchange ideas for the growth and development of their respective communities.

The Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo gave a brief background of the civic groups in Edo Central Senatorial District and the work UROMI JDPCI has been doing in various communities through the civic groups that were formed six years ago in Edo Central Senatorial District. He stated that the main purpose of the forum was to bridge the gap between the populace and government at the local level in areas of community development and getting to know first-hand what the local government plans to do in their respective communities. He advised the Council Chairmen to provide soft loans and improved seedlings to farmers and to

sensitise their people on use of improved farming methods that can boost agricultural production because of the abundance of arable land in the senatorial district.

### **IGUEBEN LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA HALL ON THE 17<sup>TH</sup> OF MAY 2018.**

The Town Hall Meeting which was held on the 17<sup>th</sup> of May, 2018 at the Council hall started at 10:20am with registration and opening prayer which was said by the Director Uromi Justice Development Peace/Caritas Initiatives, Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo. In attendance were the Executive Chairman, Igueben Local Government Area, the Divisional Police Officer, Igueben Division, The Head of Service, Igueben LGA, Chiefs and Community representatives as well as civic group members from across the communities in Igueben Local Government



**Very Rev. Fr. Fidelis Arhedo giving his opening remark**

Area. This was followed by a brief introduction by the information and media officer who explained the purpose of the town hall meeting which was tagged round table discussion after which the Director Very Rev Fr Dr. Fidelis Arhedo gave the open remark which explained the whole essence of the event.

At the end of the remark the various communities made their presentation which contained the needs of their communities to the Local Government Chairman for consideration in the budget.

In response, the chairman thanked Civic Groups for organizing the round table discussion and promised to lend his continuous support to the activities of the civic group in his domain.

### **CHAIRMAN'S RESPONSE**

**Estimated Electricity Billing:** The Chairman explained that it was beyond his power to bring about the reduction in the bills, he however noted that the issue was being handled at the State level by the Office of the Deputy Governor. But that in the meantime communities should try to acquire bulk meters from the Benin Electricity Distribution Company (BEDC) as this will go a long way in the reduction of electricity bills brought to them.



**The Chairman addressing the people**

**Grading of Roads:** The Chairman informed the gathering that he had asked councillors representing the various wards to submit the roads that needed to be graded in their respective

communities and since the communities have come to submit their the list will be given appropriate attention.

**Primary Health Centres:** The chairman reiterated his commitment to the renovation of the Health Centres across the local government area. He informed the gathering that his administration has signed an agreement with CSDP to provide 90% funding while the LGA will provide the remaining 10% for the exercise. He also promised that more staff will be posted to the

twenty health centres in the local government.

**Schools:** The Chairman stated that he is aware that cultists and other hoodlums take advantage of some dilapidated classroom blocks in some primary schools as hideouts. He assured the people that the matter will be tabled at the security meeting of the council for appropriate action.

**Markets:** The chairman informed the people that plans have reached advanced stage to make Igueben and Ebelle markets function on daily basis. Part of the plan he said was to draw meat sellers and other vendors who do daily sales to come to the market to display and sell their wares rather than sell on the street.

**Security:** The Igueben Local Government Chairman also informed the house that a bus has been refurbished, motorcycles purchased, dedicated phone numbers acquired for people to call in case of an emergency and an operational office for vigilante groups in the local government area has been assigned. One hundred and seventy five of them will be posted to schools and other establishments in the local government area.

**Farmers:** The Chairman spoke of his plans to educate farmers in all the communities on new farming methods and the use of improved seedlings to help boost agricultural production. He said that plans were also in advanced stage with IITA to help facilitate this process. The chairman also appealed to

everyone present to assist in speaking to Idumogan community to release about 10 hectares of land he

had earlier spent lots of money to clear and prepare to plant maize. The scheme, according to the chairman was to harvest the maize and sell to a ready market with the profit to be shared between the host community and the LGA. But the community resisted by ceasing the land for fear of it been taken by the government.



A community Representative making presentation on behalf of his community



The Chairman addressing the people



The Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo thanked the Chairman once again for gracing the forum with his presence and sued for his continuous support in the work the various civic groups were doing in his local government. He advised the chairman to sand-fill the earth roads before grading them and that grading of roads should be done during the dry season. He also advised the chairman to sign a memoriam of understanding (MOU) with the Idumogan community on the land issue to forestall any misunderstanding the two parties may have in the future as regards the matter. He also joined the Chairman to appeal to the community members to speak to the elders and leaders of the community to release the land to the Local Government for the noble venture they have planned to do there.



**Cross Section Of Participant And Chairman**

### **ESAN NORTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA ON THE 21<sup>ST</sup> OF MAY 2018.**

The town hall meeting which was held on the 21<sup>st</sup> of May, 2018 at the Local Government Hall, began at 11:15am with registration and opening prayer led by the Director Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives, Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo. In attendance was the Chairman of the Local government, Honourable Austin Okhoibhole, community representatives and civic group members from across the communities in Esan North East Local Government Area. After the opening remark by the Director, Uromi JDPCI community representatives took turns to read out and present the list of projects they wanted to be done in their respective communities.



**The chairman addressing the gathering**

### **CHAIRMAN RESPONSE**

In response, the Chairman, Hon Austin Okoibhole thanked Uromi JDPCI for organizing the town hall meeting and promised to lend his continuous support to the activities of the civic group in his domain. He stated that he had planned to organize a forum like this with representatives of women groups, youths and elders of various communities in the local government and that the proactive act of the civic groups have actually made things easier for him. He then requested that the civic groups should make the forum more regular as he will always be available to participate and to render his stewardship to his people.

The Chairman informed the gathering of his plans to stop street trading and to keep the local government area clean. To this end, he stated that the council had embarked on de-silting the

drains in the local government for erosion control. He warned that hence forth anyone caught throwing dirt in to gutters will be prosecuted. Hon. Austin also informed the people of the council's decision to move all round side parks to the central park in the local government for easy access of transportation and security reasons.

**Security:** In the area of crime prevention and security, the chairman spoke of the council's desire to register and give reflective vests to commercial motorcyclists working in the local government. This he said was to prevent them been used by criminals to perpetuate crimes. The Chairman further informed the people of the State Government's directives to all local government chairmen to set up a seven man committee that will be made up of members from the police, civil defence, and other security agencies that will be tasked with the responsibility to register any Fulani herdsman and cattle that enters the state or local government. This model will be replicated in every ward and community in the Local Government Area.

**Sanitation and Waste Disposal:** In the area of cleanliness, the chairman spoke of the council's plans to engage waste managers who will henceforth collect waste from the people to prevent indiscriminate dumping of waste.

**Education:** Hon. Austine Okhoibhole informed the gathering of the state government's plans to renovate one schools per ward in every Local Government Area in the state and that the community in which a school is selected will have to sign an agreement to protect the equipment and school facilities from vandals. He then promised to ensure that the schools mentioned at the town hall meeting were given priority. He also mentioned that services of education marshals will be engaged to ensure pupils and students do not roam the streets during school hours.



Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo giving the opening remark

**Health:** The chairman also mentioned that the councils intend to revamp the moribund Uzenema comprehensive Primary Health Centre to serve as a referral point for other Primary Health Centres in the Local Government Area. He added that the Primary Health Centres will also be given a face lift and refurbished to meet the needs of the people.

**Skills Acquisition centre at Obiyon:** the chairman promised to move some sewing machines from the council to the centre and revive the place so that schools and other establishments can get their uniforms sewed by people who would be engaged in the skills acquisition centre. He also promised to give good consideration to all the issues presented by the various communities since they were all in line with his plans for the Local Government Area. He noted that the budget for this year has already been prepared and that any of the items presented not captured in this budget will be captured in the next budget.



**Grading of Roads:** The Chairman stated that roads will be graded as requested and that the 1KM road leading to the Primary Health Centre in Egbele community will be constructed in addition to the grading of other roads in the community

**Agriculture:** The Chairman gave hindsight on the plans by the council to acquire and cultivate



Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo responding to chairman's remarks

large hectares of land for planting pawpaw and other crops that already have markets that will be profitable for both the community and the local government. He added that the State Government had planned to partner with Local Government for Agricultural Production but he was facing the challenge of communities not releasing land for fear that the government would take the land and not return it to them. The Director of Uromi JDPCI urged communities that have vast land to sign a memorandum of understanding with the Government to guarantee the safety of their land if they were afraid that the government may

not return their land to them after use.

He once again thanked the Chairman for gracing the forum with his presence and sued for his continuous support in the work the various civic groups were doing in his local government. He advised the chairman to fill the earth roads before grading them and that grading of roads should be done in the dry season.

## ESAN CENTRAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

The Town Hall Meeting which was held on the 24<sup>th</sup> of May, 2018 at the Council hall started at 2:05pm with registration and opening prayer which was said by the Director Uromi Justice Development Peace/Caritas Initiatives, Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo. In attendance were the Executive Chairman of the Local government, the Vice Chairman and Secretary to the Local Government, Chiefs, community representatives and civic group members from across the communities in Esan Central Local Government Area. The media and information officer welcomed all to the gathering and introduced members of the civic group present to the chairman. The Director thereafter gave the opening



The Director giving the opening remark

remark after which the various communities made their presentation which contained the needs of their

communities to the Local Government Chairman for consideration in the budget. Chief Umane from Agua community again re-emphasized the community needs and appealed to the Chairman to give the desired consideration to demand.

Chief Ehiremen Sydney from Ewu further stressed that the health centres beside renovations should be provided with borehole and electricity. He added the need to prevail on BEDC for effective service delivery and assistance to step down power supply to other part of their community that do not have electricity.

### **CHAIRMAN RESPONSE**

The Chairman appreciated the initiatives of the civic group and stated that the civic group was the only group that he has seen that do not seek their personal benefit but the good of the community and the general good of all. He noted that if the civic group sustained at all level, it will give the government the opportunity to address the true needs of the people because of their method of engagement. He noted that the needs that have been submitted were in line with the plans of the Local Government Area and the State Government who have stated that governance must be about the people. He promised to give favourable considerations to the issues that have been presented to him by the various communities. He stated that most of the requests made by the representatives of the communities were already captured in the budget. He further stated that for those that were not captured in the budget, they were noted and would reflect in the budget of next year. He promised to share a copy of the work plan and budget with Uromi JDPCI so that the civic groups can have access to it. The Chairman also informed the people that he had asked the councillors from all the wards to submit the list of roads to be graded in their communities and any other project to be added in the council's budget as such the communities were encouraged to work with their Councillors to achieve it.

The Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo thanked the chairman once again for gracing the forum with his presence and sued for his continuous support in the work the various civic groups were doing in his local government. He was pleased that the chairman was willing to share the budget and work plan of the local government with the Uromi JDPCI and promised to continually provide assistance in the area of capacity building whenever needed.

The Director told the chairman that a meeting of such would be organized after one year so that the chairman can give his stewardship.



**Chief Sydney Ehiremen addressing the Chairman**

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**Chief Umane addressing the Chairman**

## ESAN WEST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

The town hall meeting which was held on the 4<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at the Local Government Hall, began at 10:45am with registration and opening prayer led by the Director Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives, Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo. In attendance were the Chairman of the Local government, Honourable Patrick Agunede, the Vice Chairman, Chiefs, community representatives and civic group members from across the communities in Esan West Local Government Area. The Director Uromi



The Director giving the opening remark, while the Chairman and the Vice Chairman sit beside him

JDPCI Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo gave the opening remark which was followed by the presentations of community needs by the community representatives.

### CHAIRMAN'S RESPONSE

The Chairman expressed appreciation for the opportunity that the town hall meeting has created for him to interact with his people and then went further to explain and respond to issues raised



The Chairman addressing the people

**Revenue:** He explained to participants in the forum that the council was indebted to the tune of four hundred and sixty six million naira only and still had backlog of salaries to pay to workers and then assured the people that the financial challenges will not deterred him from providing good governance to the people as he has already set plans in place to overcome the situations.

**Market:** He promised to build 10 markets in 10 wards with the assistance of CSDP at Local Government Area because he understood the importance commerce plays in the lives of the people of Esan West Local Government Area. He added that he already has counterpart funding arrangement with CSDP.

**Grading of Road:** Mr Chairman promised that by the dry season he would grade all the earth roads in the Local Government, during which he would assign a grader to each ward for a period of 6 days. Each community were to work with the grader to ensure their needs were met.

**Erosion Control:** As part of palliative work to help check the erosion menace ravaging several roads in the Local Government Area, the Chairman spoke of plans to de-silt tunnel/drainages at Opoji, Ujoelen and some strategic junctions to reduce the erosion.

**Crime Prevention and Security:** the chairman spoke of the council's desire to register and give slots to five representatives from each community per ward to monitor the movements of suspicious individuals in the community. He requested that the names be given to him before the end of the round table discussion session for necessary action.

**Education:** Hon. Aguinode informed the people of the state governments plans to renovate schools in the state but only after agreements have been signed with members of the communities where the schools are located to ensure the equipment and school facilities are protected from vandals. He also mentioned that services of education marshals will be engaged to ensure pupils and students do not roam the streets during school hours.



Group photograph with the Chairman

The Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo concluded by suggesting to the Chairman to sand- fill the earth roads before grading them and then commended his desire to promote good governance in the Local Government Area

## **ESAN SOUTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA**

The Town Hall Meeting which was held on the 14<sup>th</sup> of June, 2018 at the Council hall started at 11:30am with registration and opening prayer which was said by the Director Uromi Justice Development Peace/Caritas Initiatives, Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo. In attendance were the Executive Chairman of the Local government, Member Representing Esan South East Local Government Area in Edo State House of Assembly Hon. Festus Edughele, the Vice Chairman, elected councillors representing various communities, supervising councillors, Chiefs (Iyasele of Ewatto and Oniha of Ubiaja), community representatives and civic group members from across the communities in Esan South East Local Government Area. The Director thereafter gave the opening remark which was followed by presentations of community needs by the various communities.



The Director making a remark

Chief Iyasele of Ewatto Kingdom appreciated Uromi JDPCI and the Civic Groups who initiated this intervention because it was not an easy task to have this type of meeting with the chairman, that the civic group could make this possible, is highly commendable.



## CHAIRMAN RESPONSE

The Chairman thanked UROMI JDPCI and the civic group members for providing a platform for him to tell the people of the Local Government his plans and appealed for the continuous partnership and support of the group to help bring about meaningful development across communities in the Local Government Area. He commended the initiative of the civic groups and their communities to call for a town hall meeting to



The LGA Chairman addressing the people

begin the administration of the Local Government Area with him and requested the people to measure his impact on the various communities after a period of 6 months. He added that he went round some communities immediately he resumed Office and that what they communities have presented now were not different from what he was told at the communities he visited. He noted that it was based on that survey that he has designed a master plan for the year 2018 which he shared with the people as he respond to their needs.

**ELECTRICITY SUPPLY:** The Chairman noted that he has submitted a situation report based on the complaint he earlier received to the deputy Governor and that hopefully there will be improved supply when the proposed planning by state Governor begin to manifest. He added that they have discovered that payments for bills were not getting to the appropriate quarter was why they said people and communities were owning.



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Group photograph of participants

**WATER:** He noted that the government was working to resolve the dispute in Ugboha Dam and when that is resolve plans to ensure adequate water supply to the various communities in Esan South East LGA will commence.

**HEALTH CENTRES:** The plans for the reactivation of health centres has reached an advanced stage. He noted that he may not be building new ones but he will make the existing ones active.

**GRADING OF ROADS:** The Chairman stated that grading of roads will be given due consideration but let it be known that he may not be able to grade all the roads at once but the ones that have be presented by the various communities will be given due attention.

The Member Representing Esan South East Local Government Area in Edo State House of Assembly Hon. Festus Edughele expressed his happiness to be part of the town hall meeting which was adjudged needful and useful for participatory democracy. He appreciated the





**Festus Edughele addressing the people**

chairman for his expressed commitment to deliver on the needs presented to him by the various communities. He reiterated his commitment to promote community development by highlighting his contribution to resolving security problem that bedeviled the communities in the LGA. He also stated his involvement in rural electrification project and many other projects which has been influenced to the communities through him. He expressed his readiness

to partner with the LGA Chairman to ensure that the needed development was achieved.

In response the Director of Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo advised the Chairman to sand-fill the earth roads before grading them and suggested that the grading of roads be done in the dry season. He also expressed his pleasure for been able to hold a forum like this with the chairman of a Local Government Area present which has not been the case before now. He expressed gratitude to the council Chairman for sharing copies of his plans with the civic groups and community members. He also used the opportunity to inform the Chairman that a follow up forum would be organized towards the end of the year to ascertain the level of achievement of the projects presented by the communities.

### **SUSTAINABLE MECHANISM FOR IMPROVING LIVELIHOOD AND HOUSEHOLD EMPOWERMENT (SMILE) PROJECT**

Uromi JDPCI conducted activities that were geared towards the provision of quality need based services to enrolled Vulnerable Children and their households. Some of these services were rendered during home visits to households, such as nutritional counseling and growth monitoring while some others such as kids' club and care givers' forum were held in open places within the communities. This quarter also saw the commencement of another phase of the Adolescent Girls intervention in Egbele community.

Uromi JDPCI conducted some outreaches and campaigns to create access to HIV services in the various communities and ensure that beneficiaries know their HIV status. This quarter also saw the continuous use of HIV risk assessment tool to help track those who have not known their status within the last six months. Some community dialogues were also conducted to reduce stigma and discrimination as well as outreaches for health education to promote healthy living in the project communities.

As part of household economic strengthening efforts, Uromi JDPCI has continued to support the running of SILC groups that were formed within project communities and also presented cheques for cash transfer to another set of beneficiaries as well as support some households with improved agricultural seedlings.

## Health Education

This reporting period saw Uromi JDPCI carry out 6 outreaches on health education. These outreaches focused on educating the beneficiaries, especially women on environmental hygiene. Sensitization on HIV and TB prevention and control was also done. A total of 65 (40 females and 25 male) beneficiaries were in attendance at the various communities. Sensitization on HIV prevention, care and treatment were also conducted during the period.

## Community Dialogue

As part of the effort to reduce stigma and discrimination against people living with HIV, Uromi JDPCI conducted 8 community dialogues in eight communities. The dialogue meetings had in attendance stake holders from the different communities who promised to extend the sensitization to those in their care. 108 community stake holders (71 men; 37 women) were reached with community dialogue in this reporting period.

## Kids' Club



Kids' club session

In the quarter under review a total of 109 kids/youth clubs were conducted in eight (8) communities (Obeidu, Ivue, Eror, Obiyon, Efandion, Onewa, Egbele and Ebhoiyi) with a total of 3238 children made up of 1503 males and 1735 females in attendance. These activities were conducted in an interactive manner such that the children had the opportunity to ask questions and contribute to discussion. It also was to build their confidence to

effectively communicate with their peers and parent and so as to be able to play relevant role in the family. The topics discussed

in this quarter were how to build confidence and effective communication using my five best points, communicating our strengths and our trees of life.

## Care givers forum

A total of 74 care givers fora were held in 8 communities (Obeidu, Ivue, Eror, Egbele, Onewa, Obiyon, Efandion and Ebhoiyi) with 1165 care givers made up of 32 males and 1133 females reached. The care givers forum has continued to provide relevant and educative information for caregivers that participated in them on better parenting through topics like; setting limits, responding to misbehavior and good discipline. The caregivers during the sessions expressed appreciation to the project for the introduction of the platform.



Adolescent Girls club in session

## **DOLESCENT GIRLS PILOT INTERVENTION**

Uromi JDPCI has commenced the implementation of the Adolescent Girls intervention in Egbele community. The club held its first session on 29<sup>th</sup> of June 2018 with 60 Adolescent Girls within the age bracket of 10-13 and 14-17 in attendance. The meeting was subsequently fixed to hold twice a week to be able to complete the sessions before the end of the project.

### **Orientation for Beneficiaries of Start Up Kits**

As a follow up to the distribution of start-up kits to 21 beneficiaries in the month of March, the Technical Officer for Food and Nutrition came to Uromi JDPCI in the month of April to conduct business orientation workshop for the beneficiaries. The beneficiaries all participated and expressed thanks for the knowledge gained.



**Flag off ceremony for cash transfer**

### **Cash Transfer**

A total of 109 households who were selected for the cash transfer exercise all benefited from cash transfer and they have all cashed their cheques. The activity was marked with a flag-off ceremony at the Palace of the Ojuromi of Uromi Kingdom on the 10<sup>th</sup> of May, 2018.

### **Agricultural Input**

A total of 307 (three hundred and seven) caregivers benefited from the distribution of high quality protein maize (HQPM - 171) and Pro vitamin A (VA - 136) across the whole project communities.



**Distribution of Agric inputs to caregivers**

### **Food Bank**

A total of 17 caregiver/households benefited from the distribution of yams (3 tubers each) from the food bank in Obeidu community. The yams were contributed by members of the community for the service of the most vulnerable ones in their midst.

### **Monthly growth monitoring and Promotion**

The regular growth monitoring was carried out in the 8 communities (Ivue, Egbele, Obeidu, Efandion, Ebhoiyi, Onewa, Eror and Obiyon.) using anthropometric measurements (weight, MUAC and height). All of the children assessed were observed to be growing well based on the measurement and the caregivers were commended. A total of 1,658 (801 males and 857 females) persons were reached.

## **Nutrition education and counseling**

Nutrition education and counseling involves processes whereby caregivers are counseled on good nutrition following result from growth monitoring of their children so as to improve the quality of their diets and that of their children.

The Nutrition key Message booklet was used to discuss the importance of Nutrition for the whole household. Caregivers were counseled based on the food present in the community, emphasizing that good food is the best investment which they can make for their household. Special emphases were on the pregnant women, lactating mothers and children because of nutritional needs. In addition, caregivers were educated on the

importance of home garden as a source of fresh and natural food. Some of the crops agreed by the caregivers to plant in their garden during planting season were okra, maize, green leaf, garden egg, pumpkin and water melon. A total of 654 caregivers (84males and 570females) were reached



**Community IYCF meeting**

## **IYCF Mother to Mother Support group meetings**

Promoting and supporting good IYCF practices is a key to preventing malnutrition. Children up to 2 years old are particularly vulnerable hence, the group is made of lactating mothers, pregnant women, elderly mothers, young girls and men.



**Caregivers forum in Session**

Participants made contributions on the above named topics based on their knowledge; the elderly women present at the meetings encouraged the younger ones on the nutritional benefits of breastfeeding while those that started the meeting early discouraged other members on the dangers of mixed feeding during the first six months of life. A total of 16 meetings were held with 212 caregivers-all female

## **ANTI HUAN TRAFFICKING DESK**

### **PROTECTION OF MIGRANTS AND ASYLUM SEEKERS ESPECIALLY CHILDREN AND WOMEN COMING FROM NIGERIA AND VICTIMS OF TRAFFICKING (PACKING)**

In a bid to successfully complete the assessment and enrolment of students in the schools where step down training on human trafficking was done, Uromi JDPCI Project team actively participated in the final set of assessment/enrolment in 10 schools bringing the total number of



schools assessed to 69. In the 10 schools visited, a total of 460 students (121males &339 females were assessed and enrolled out of which the most vulnerable students will be selected for empowerment after their households must have been assessed to correlate the information of the students. The Schools visited were: Ugbegun Grammer School, Shiloh Hill, Kings Community School, Ugun Secondary School, Igueben College, public secondary schools in Ewossa, Ebelle, Ekekhen, Igueben Grammer School and Wisdom Group of Schools.

This was a fulfilment of the promise made to conclude the enrolment of beneficiaries in the remaining schools as soon as schools resume, Uromi JDPCI carried out the exercise in the above named schools, employing many hands to ensure its completion as early as possible so as not to disrupt academic activities in the schools visited.



A staff assessing a student in one of the schools visited

Uromi JDPCI expresses her appreciation to the school authorities and the staff assigned by the various schools to support the process by whose effort the exercise was hitch free.

This intervention is vital for the survival and welfare of in-school girls and their Care-Givers. This is because Uromi JDPCI, from previous experiences in other projects has seen the need to engage vulnerable households in the area of economic empowerment to reduce vulnerability and susceptibility to human trafficking. The project is intended to provide economic empowerment to 50 in-school students and their caregivers across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District with a mandate to collaborate with GPI who have provided stepdown training on human trafficking to students in 71 public schools across Esan land so as to ensure that the beneficiaries become aware and less susceptible to human trafficking through training and empowerment of their care givers



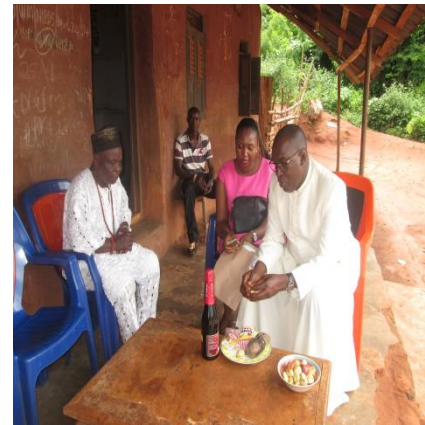
Another staff conducting assessment

## **THE CAMPAIGN ON ANTI-HUMAN TRAFICKING AND SAFE MIGRATION (CAT-SaM) PROJECT IN ESAN NORTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA, EDO STATE**

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives (Uromi JDPCI) entered into partnership with Catholic Caritas Foundation of Nigeria (CCFN) to conduct intensive campaigns



in five communities (Obeidu/Ivue, Eror, Egbele, Efandion and Obiyon) in Esan North East Local Government Area being one of the LGAs covered by the Catholic Diocese of Uromi. Part of the intervention will focus on the identification and selection of volunteers to act as Community Watch Groups in the selected communities while mobilization for sensitization and rallies will be targeted at the selected communities, markets, motor packs, law enforcement agencies and schools. The aim is to create awareness on the dangers of human trafficking and irregular migration as well as sensitize them on tips for safe migration.



**The Director with Chief Oniha  
accompanied by Barr Onomen from CCFN**

Uromi JDPCI commenced the implementation of activities with advocacy visits to Chiefs and community leaders in six communities (Obeidu/Ivue, Eror, Egbele, Efandion and Obiyon) with the aim of introducing the project to them and soliciting their cooperation to achieve a successful and sustained implementation in their communities. School heads in three Primary Schools were also visited while sensitization was conducted in Obeidu Primary school all in Esan North East Local Government Area.

During the advocacy visits the project team was received by the Odionweles and elders of the selected communities. Chiefs with such communities were also visited, among which were chief Onogbosele, Chief Iyasele, Chief Oniha and Chief Oza. The team of Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives (JDPCI) led by the Director Very Rev. Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo who is also the Provincial Coordinator of JDPC in Benin Province and a representative of Caritas Nigeria, Barr. Oriakhi Onomen informed the stakeholders of the desire of the Organization to work in his community. He stated that Uromi JDPCI in collaboration with Catholic Caritas Foundation of Nigeria will be conducting sensitization and enlightenment campaign on the dangers of human trafficking in the community. He noted that the endemic nature of human trafficking in Esan North East Local Government Area particularly Uromi has made the intervention very necessary. As such efforts need to be put in place to sensitize the communities and people in Esan North East



**Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo presenting  
kolanut to the Odionwele in company of Barr  
Onomen from CCFN**

Local Government Area so as to reduce susceptibility to human trafficking and reduce the prevalence of irregular migration.

He added that young people, especially the girls succumb to pressure from their parents/guardians who often compare them to other females to travel abroad and brought wealth to their families. This group of young people often become highly vulnerable to traffickers and would

therefore succumb to oath taking, debt bondage and other hideous activities which basically violate their human rights, just to be taken out of their villages with a promise of a brighter future that they may never get.

He used the opportunity to encourage the community leaders to align with the Oba of Benin pronouncement on traffickers, which has nullify oaths taken/debt bonds and to inform all who are accomplices to this heinous crime in their community to desist or face the consequences as expressed by Oba Ewuare II recently in Edo State.

Fr. Arhedo further explained that to reduce the vulnerability of young girls/boys and children in Edo State to trafficking which could end them in sexual exploitation and child labor, the project will be engaging in awareness creation and campaign on safe migration tips. The project will also train five community members who will be selected by the community elders as Community Watch Groups in the community. He further implored the permission of the stakeholders to address a general gathering of their various communities so as to sensitize them and create the needed awareness on human trafficking and irregular migration.

The Chiefs and community heads thanked the Director and his team for the kind gesture and promised to cooperate with the organization to achieve this goal. They lamented the mass exodus of youth from their communities due to this irregular migration and described the situation as unfortunate. They promised to call the director as soon as possible to address the community on the danger of human trafficking and irregular migration after due consultation with other elders on which date will best suit the people.

The head teachers of Awo, Amendokhian and Iruale primary schools who were also visited during the advocacy visits acknowledged the importance of catching them young and then commended the initiatives for taking children and adolescents into consideration. They promised to lend their

support towards the intervention and to give the project team a date for the sensitization exercise in their respective schools.



**The Director addressing the head teacher in Amendokhian Primary School in company of Barr Onomen from CCFN**

## **SENSITIZATION IN OBEIDU PRIMARY SCHOOL**

In a like manner Uromi JDPCI project team led by the Executive Director Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo were in Obeidu Primary, Uromi to create awareness on the dangers of irregular migration. The Director who anchored the sensitization explained to the students that the team was in their school because of their importance to the future. He encouraged them to be mindful of the people around them especially when they want to take them away from their communities, because if they end up being trafficked they will not be able to complete their education. He told to learn to say no to offers that will make house helps or expose them to child labour. He

explained in elementary terms the mode and elements of trafficking. The children were asked to look around their communities and observed those who have return after being trafficked and what their lives have turned into. Some of the children said the victims usually get down with sickness which most of the time lead to their death. He then advised them to watch out for certain acts that were common to most traffickers which were always built on deceit. Barr



**Barr Onomen addressing the students in Obeidu Primary School**

Onomen who was also present at the sensitization exercise told the students that human trafficking can come in any form, as such if they parent ask them to go to the city to stay with some body they should refuse and if possible report to their teachers for

investigation and linkage to source of help.



**Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo addressing the students in Obeidu Primary School**

The Director again encouraged the teachers to be close to their students so that they can always confide in them. The head teacher thanked the project team and sued for more collaboration on issues of this nature.

## **PRISON APOSTOLATE**

As the welfare of inmates as become a priority Uromi JDPCI organized health talk on drug abuse and invited a member of the nurses guide in Uromi Dioceses (Mrs V.A Momoh) as a guest speaker. The purpose of the lecture was to sensitize the inmates on the dangers and negative effects of drug abuse. The type of drugs that are being abused, what leads to abusing drugs, those involved in drugs abuse, Symptoms of drug abuse, management of drug abusers, prevention of drug abuse among other things. After the sensitization opportunities was given to inmates to ask questions for clarification. At the lecture a total of 45 inmates and 1 officer were reached.



**Sensitization on dangers of Drugs Abuse in Prison**

Also in the second quarter bible study was conducted for inmates and **reflection** was taken from psalm **102:23**, and the topic was **God of Mercy**, at the end of the program 12 inmates participated.

## **MICRO CREDIT DESK**

Meeting the basic needs of the vulnerable members of the society has been one of the core goal of the Uromi JDPCI and this has always been achieved through empowerment of these target population using the Micro-Credit/PROMIC scheme as a platform. The strategy employed by the Uromi JDPCI was through the use of soft loans which are strictly for active poor women and active farmers in the society. This scheme is opened to Catholics and Non Catholics within the Diocese of Uromi.



**A session of PROMIC beneficiaries before disbursement**

The Uromi JDPCI is currently running the scheme in four (4) platforms namely: Group Micro-Credit, PROMIC1, PROMIC 2 and AGRC-PROMIC (for farmers) respectively. A total of seven hundred and nine (709) persons are currently benefiting from these platforms. A total of two hundred (200) persons from fourteen (14) groups are currently benefiting from PROMIC I scheme, PROMIC 2 has Sixteen (16) groups comprising of one hundred and fifty eight (158) persons. AGRIC PROMIC has Eleven(11) groups comprising of one hundred and twelve (112) persons, with membership strength of eight – fifteen (8-15) persons per group. Another ten (10) groups which comprises of one hundred and fifty (150) persons are benefiting from the group micro credit scheme for petty traders while A total of seventy one (71) persons from five (5) groups are currently benefiting from agric micro credit for farmers.



**Cross section of beneficiaries of Agric promic during formation and training.**

A recent visit to some of the serving groups this quarter showed that beneficiaries have gainfully invested their soft loan in their businesses in line with the objectives of the scheme during individual interview. Uromi JDPCI thanked the groups and urged them to co-operate with the scheme by paying up their loan sum and outstanding debts as and when due. The various group leaders also appreciated Uromi JDPCI and promised to improve on their commitment repayment so as to clear their debts with interest in the next quarter.